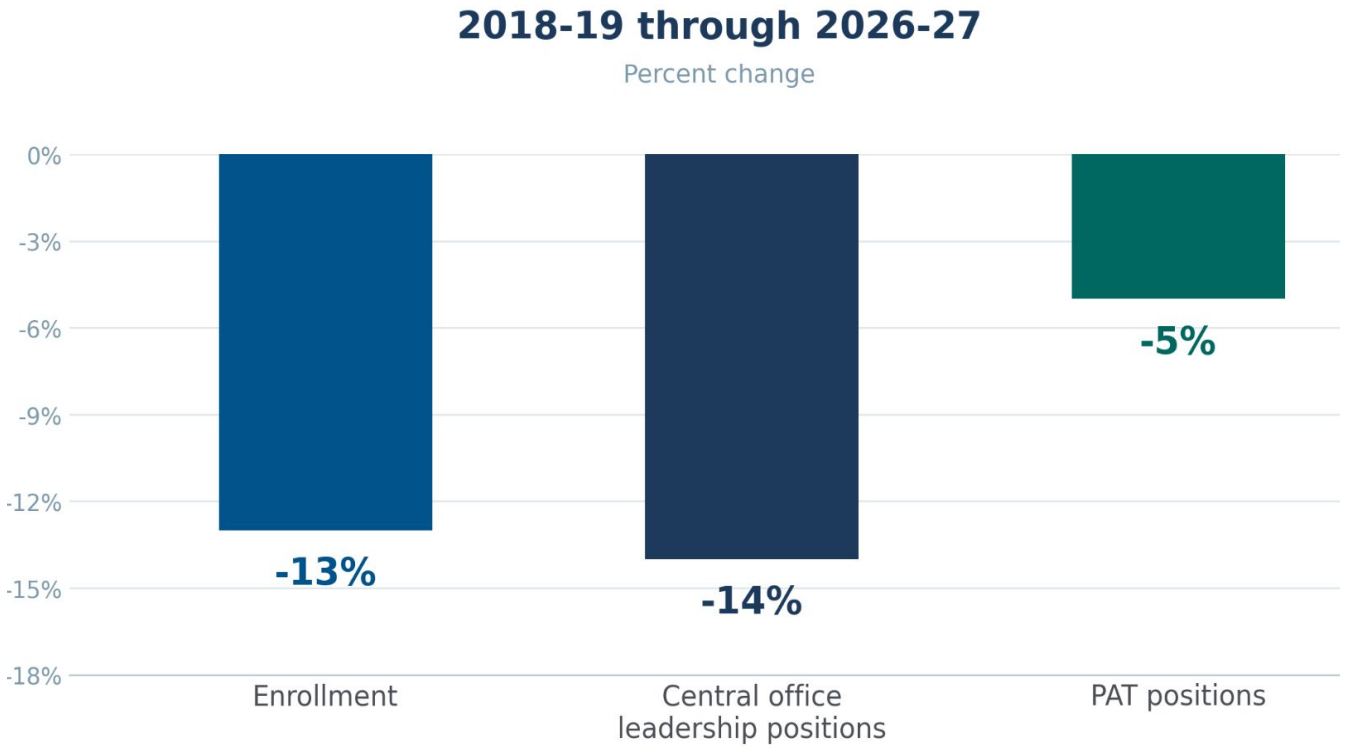
Reductions Have Been Intentionally Proportional



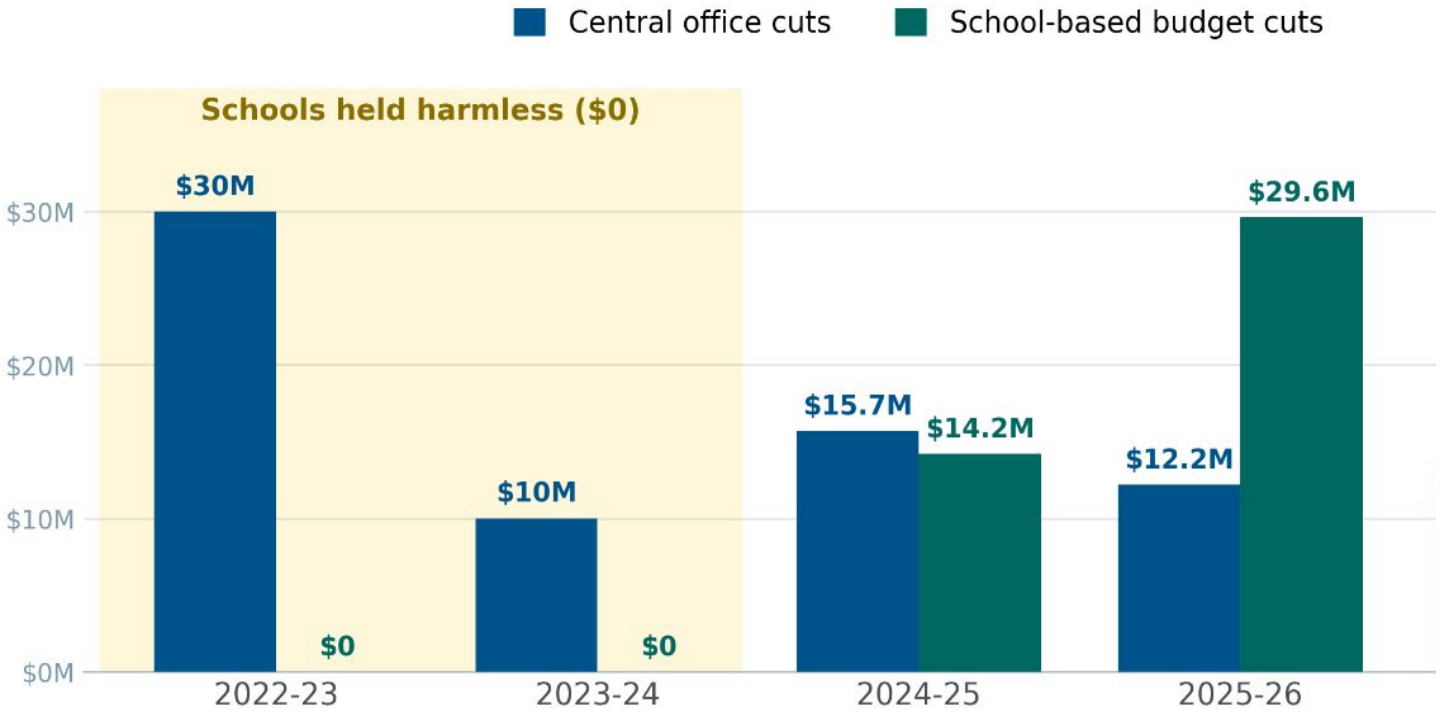
Source: HRIS data and PPS enrollment data.

What This Shows:

When enrollment declined 13%, the district deliberately held teacher reductions to only 5% while reducing central office leadership (Program Admin and above) by 14%.

This two-decade strategic choice prioritized classrooms. We have now reached the structural limit of this approach.

Central Office took the first and largest budget reductions before schools were impacted



What This Shows:

For two years, schools were held harmless while the central office absorbed reductions. Only after years of structural deficit pressure did reductions begin reaching schools.

Cumulative Reductions: Central Office $67.9M | Schools $43.8M

Service Area Change from 2025-26 Adopted to 2026-27 Proposed

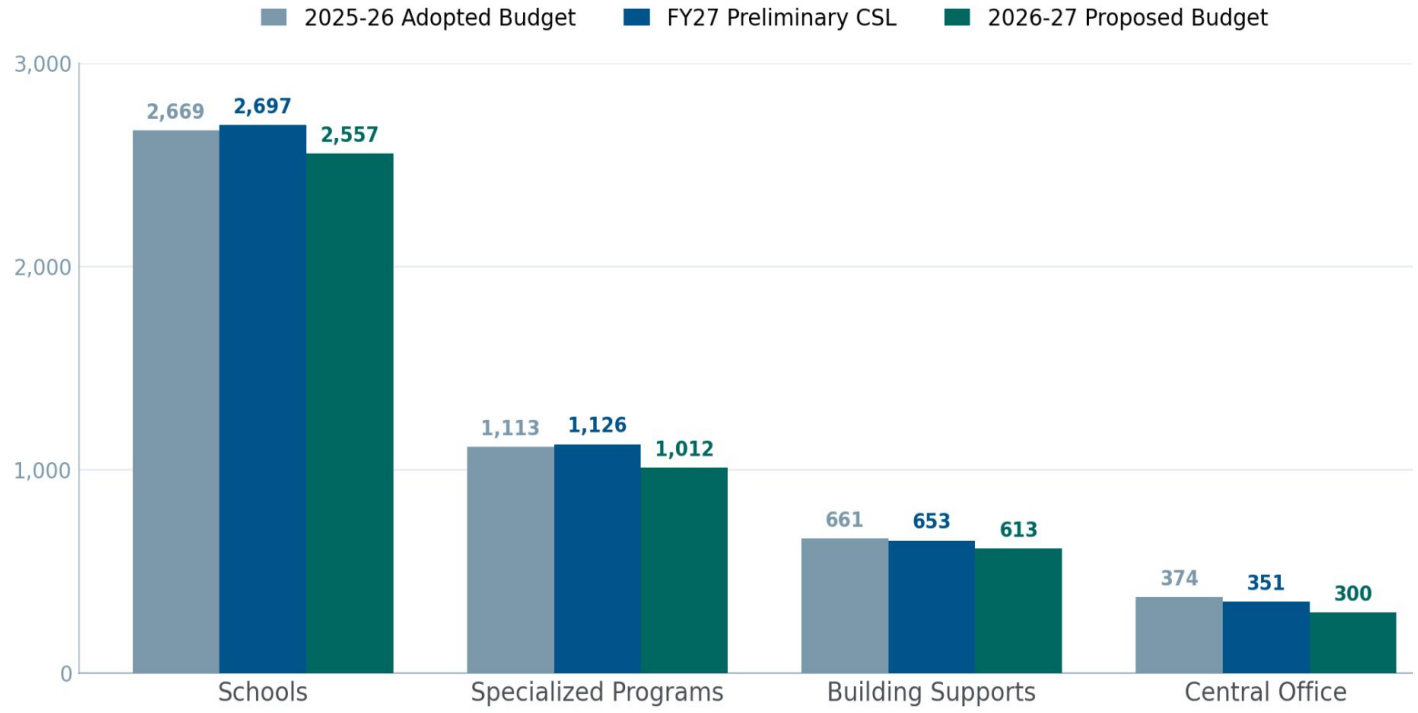
General Fund

Cost Center Area	FY26 Adopted Budget	FY27 Preliminary CSL*	Gap Closing Reductions	FY27 Proposed Budget
Building Supports	123,320,777	125,113,550	3,376,040	128,489,590
Central Office	88,936,591	89,474,106	-13,176,170	76,297,936
Schools	431,774,055	459,314,235	-20,469,284	438,844,951
Specialized Programs	166,525,728	172,989,450	-14,564,944	158,424,506
Transfers, Vacancy Savings, & Contingency	38,252,612	51,714,508	-10,636,943	41,077,565
Charter Schools Distribution	19,770,508	19,792,227	-814,719	18,977,508
Totals	868,580,271	918,398,076	-56,286,020	862,112,056

* CSL - Current Service Level represents the future cost of current service level activities and captures future rising costs

FTE Changes

General Fund

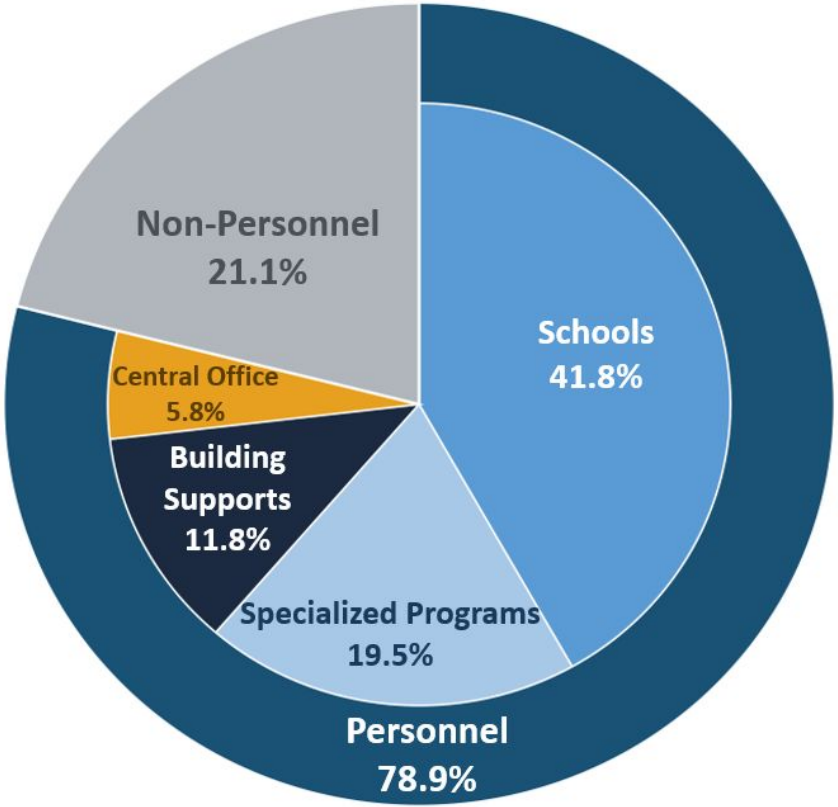


What This Shows:

- Total General Fund 4,481 FTE
- 7% Decrease from Current Service Level
- Central Office 15% Decrease
- Specialized Programs 10% Decrease
- Building Supports 6% Decrease
- Schools 5% Decrease

* CSL - Current Service Level represents the future cost of current service level activities

Most District Dollars Reach Schools



Source: FY 2027 Budgeted Positions

What This Shows:

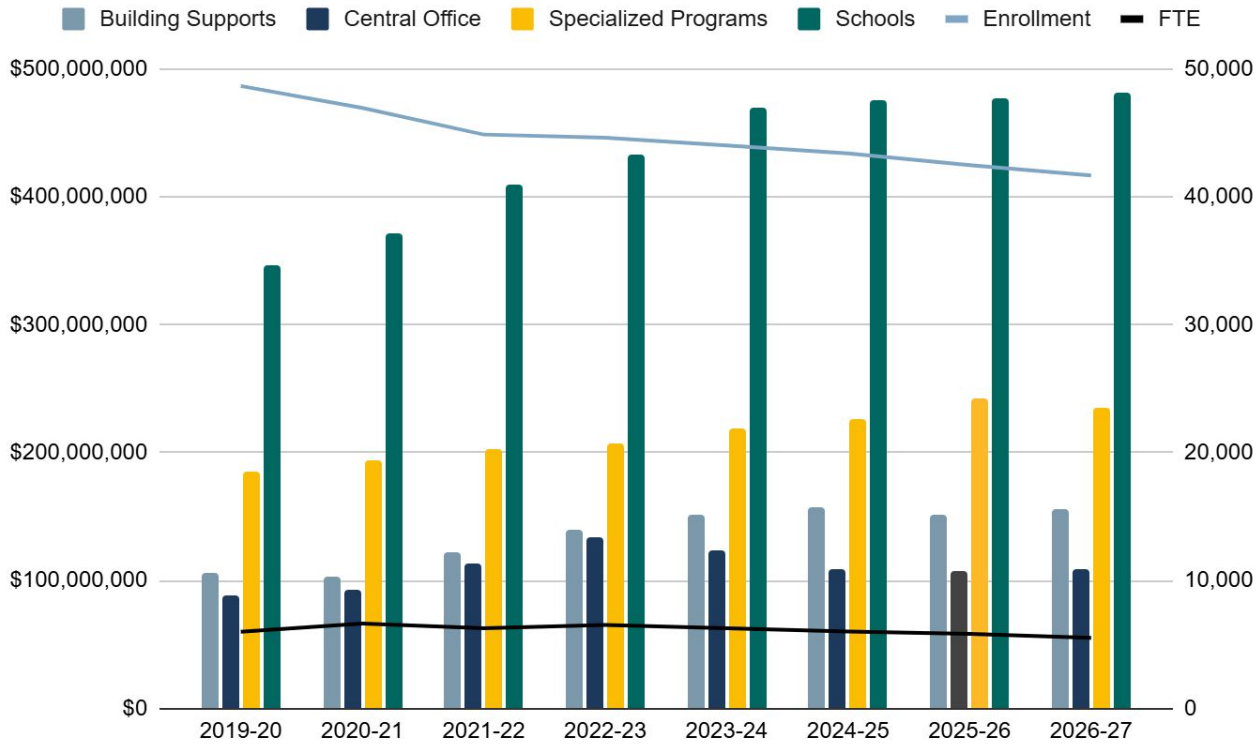
Budget composition by personnel category. Central office accounts for just 5.8% of the budget. Nearly 8 of every 10 dollars pay the people who work directly in schools and with students.

79% of spending goes to people, and the vast majority of those people (~ 70%) work in schools, teaching, feeding, transporting, and supporting students.

National benchmark: It typically takes 5–8% of a district's budget to run central office. PPS is at 5.8% — the low end of that range.

Source: AASA & NCES

Increased Spend and Decreased Enrollment



What This Shows: Focusing on General Fund and Special Revenue Fund spend, most areas of spend have increased while enrollment has decreased, although Central Office spending trended down starting in 2022-23. Staffing costs are increasing even as FTE is decreasing.

The Central Office Roles

- Central office positions represent the Board’s investment in school support to achieve the Board's priorities.
- Central office teams develop instructional resources, provide professional learning, support continuous improvement efforts, and implement strategies to accelerate student achievement.
- Many positions support students receiving special education services, interventions, multilingual learners, and other supports.
- These teams advance equity and meet legal obligations by ensuring compliance with state and federal requirements.
- Changes to these positions affect the district's capacity to support schools, build educator effectiveness, monitor student outcomes, and achieve the Board's adopted goals.

In District and Out of District Travel

- Over 95% of “In District Travel” expenses are for Special Education staff, IT technicians, and student service workers, and other support staff who are driving between our campus buildings to deliver direct support to kids.
- “Out of District Travel” is distributed across departments and includes the Superintendent and School Board. This discretionary area has been restricted during the spending freeze.
- During non-restricted spending periods, “Out of District” funds provide professional development and networking opportunities for recruitment, legal updates, certification, compliance training, student transportation for athletics, and safety training.

Contract Services Increase

- The increase to contract costs are in the Capital Project funds as we begin 3 high school modernization projects and other bond projects.
- There are also significant increases in the general fund to student transportation and other property services- areas that were under budgeted in 2025-26.
- Some services are either itinerant or require specialized training, equipment and warranty.
- Budget holders continue to evaluate contract services as they are invoiced and paid to ensure best value.

Purchased Services by Major Fund (in thousands)

Major Fund	2025-26 Adopted	2026-27 Approved	$ Change	% Change	Notes
100- General Fund	$104,835	$110,672	$5,837	5.6%	Student transportation providers, utilities, technical support
200- Special Revenue	$43,821	$53,595	$9,774	22.3%	Student transportation, community partners
300- Debt Service	$0	$0	$0	None	No Services
400- Capital Projects (Bond)	$120,707	$272,150	$151,443	125.5%	Modernizations and other facilities improvements
600- Internal Services	$557	$557	$0	0.0%	Liability Insurance
Total	**$269,919**	**$436,973**	**$167,054**	**61.9%**	